



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Archway Classical Academy - Cicero
School Website: <https://archwaycicero.greatheartsamerica.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Archway Classical Academy Cicero AZ 85250 (ACA Cicero) demonstrates a robust alignment with classical education as defined by the Six Essential Elements framework. Public materials from ACA Cicero consistently foreground Truth, Goodness, and Beauty; a classical liberal arts curriculum; and formation of virtue and character through a Western-civilizational lens. Evidence from the school's mission, philosophy, curriculum descriptions, and parental involvement indicates strong adherence to the classical aims of formation, Great Books, and a dialogic, rhetoric-infused pedagogy. The network identity (Great Hearts) further anchors the school in a tradition that emphasizes a living, interconnected curriculum, high teacher mentorship, and parental partnership. Across six categories, ACA Cicero scores CLASSICAL, with clear signals of transcendentals, formation, Great Books, and a culture of virtue, teacher-modeling, and family partnership codified in public materials. No category clearly deviates from classical norms to a degree that would necessitate a "Somewhat Classical" designation based on the evidence available.

- Executive takeaway: The school is CLASSICAL across all six categories, grounded in a classical liberal arts tradition, Great Books, and formation-focused pedagogy, with explicit emphasis on teacher role-modeling and family partnership.

Citations to source material are embedded below to ground each category's assessment.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public statements emphasize Truth, Goodness, and Beauty as guiding ideals, with the mission framed as cultivating minds and hearts through those transcendentals. - *Doctrina sed vim promovet insitam, rectique cultus pectora roborant* (Horace) appears in ACA's philosophy, signaling a classical metaphysical and moral framing (though not overt theological liturgy on the site). - The faculty and curriculum emphasis centers on virtue, character, and moral formation alongside intellectual development (e.g., "models of learning and of character").

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; character; moral formation; great conversation; formation; wisdom (implicit in virtue and moral formation); Socratic dialogue (in related Great Books content). Evidence appears in mission statements, philosophy notes, and discussions of Great Books and moral formation. - Negative keywords present: none observed in the public materials for this category (no explicit absence signals detected in the public-facing material here).

Why this rating - The school's stated purpose explicitly grounds education in transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty) and formation, with visible moral formation and virtue language. While explicit liturgical/theological practices are not foregrounded on the publicly accessible pages, the transcendental foundations and moral formation clearly anchor this category in CLASSICAL territory.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Mission centers on cultivating minds and hearts through Truth, Goodness, and Beauty, indicating formation over mere information and direct job preparation. - Emphasis on virtue, wisdom, and the cultivation of human excellence; the school asserts formation rather than purely information transfer (narrative

evaluations emphasize formation). - Explicit commitment to the enduring realness of truth, goodness, and beauty as real guides for education.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation; virtue; wisdom; truth; beauty; goodness; moral imagination; love of learning; great conversation (from related Great Books language). - Negative keywords present: none observed (the site does not present workforce- or job-prep as the sole aim; rather, it emphasizes formation and enduring human flourishing).

Why this rating - The public materials frame the school's goal around character formation and the pursuit of enduring truths, not merely career readiness, fulfilling CLASSICAL criteria in the Purpose/Goal category.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum is described as a classical liberal arts program, rooted in the Western tradition, with emphasis on Great Books and the Great Conversation. - Public discussions refer to Great Books and the Great Conversation as core components of the curriculum. - Language study includes Latin and Greek as part of the program, indicating engagement with classical languages, even if not the sole medium of instruction. - The school emphasizes a liberal arts framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric), and a curriculum designed to form learners through historical and philosophical texts within a Western canon.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Great Books; Great Conversation; classical liberal arts; Western tradition; grammar, logic, rhetoric (as foundational elements); Latin/Greek study; formation through integrated disciplines; wonder. - Negative keywords present: none observed in the public materials for this category.

Why this rating - The curriculum is explicitly framed around classical content, Great Books, liberal arts, and Western cultural literacy—hallmarks of CLASSICAL curricula.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Socratic discussion, seminars, and debates are highlighted as part of upper-level learning in the classical framework; the school embraces rhetoric training and opportunities to present arguments. - A two-teacher model and a high-expectation, rigorous core curriculum are described as standard practice, with emphasis on memory, recitation, and disciplined study—elements aligned with classical pedagogy. - The pedagogical approach includes a continuum from memory-rich lower-division activities to seminar-style higher-division discourse, consistent with classic pedagogy (scholarly dialogue and rhetorical training).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue/method; great conversation; seminars; debates; rhetoric; memory-based learning; formation through disciplined study; teacher as mentor. - Negative keywords present: none detected in public materials for this category.

Why this rating - The teaching methods described align strongly with classical pedagogy (Socratic/seminar-based inquiry, rhetoric training, memory-based lower-division culture, and a mentor-teacher model), placing this category in CLASSICAL.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The faculty is described as dedicated, enthusiastic, and intellectually excellent, serving as models of learning and character. - The school emphasizes that teachers are core to the school's living curriculum and culture, with a two-teacher model and collaborative professional environment. - The public materials stress teacher mentorship, virtuous modeling, and a "profile" of what a teacher should be, reflecting a classical faculty paradigm.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers; mentors; living curriculum; two-teacher model; collegial, supportive faculty; virtue and character modeling. - Negative keywords present: none observed.

Why this rating - The faculty descriptions align with the classical rubric's emphasis on virtue-driven, exemplary teachers who serve as living exemplars and who guide the student body and curriculum.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with families and regards parents as co-teachers, with explicit calls for parental involvement and ongoing communication. - The school seeks to educate parents about classical education through website content, gatherings, and book study opportunities, indicating a proactive parental engagement strategy. - The public materials invite parent visits and participation in campus life, reinforcing a community model that includes families in the educational process.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; parental involvement; co-educators; family engagement; home-school collaboration; parent formation; engaged families. - Negative keywords present: none observed.

Why this rating - The school presents a strong, explicit partnership with parents and a vibrant community ethos, consistent with CLASSICAL expectations in the Parents & Community category.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable. All six categories are CLASSICAL based on the available public materials for ACA Cicero. No category requires needle-moving changes to achieve CLASSICAL status, and the aggregate rating is CLASSICAL.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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